Rose hip soup is very popular in Scandinavia, where it is served both chilled and hot. Fresh rose hips are best, but you can make it with presoaked dried rose hips.

rose hip soup

SERVES 4 **PREP** 30 MINS **COOK** 1 HR PLUS 1 HR CHILLING **FREEZE** NOT SUITABLE

CHILLED

1lb 2oz (500g) ripe rose hips, rinsed
1 vanilla pod, split lengthwise
superfine sugar to taste
½ cup heavy (whipping) cream
3 tbsp natural yogurt
2 tbsp lemon juice
1¾oz (50g) slivered almonds, toasted and sprinkled with sugar
Amaretti cookies, to serve

1 Put the rose hips in a large saucepan and pour in enough boiling water to cover generously. Add the vanilla pod. Simmer over low heat for about 20–30 minutes until soft. Strain over a bowl, but reserve and set aside the cooking liquid as well as the vanilla pod.

2 Place the sieve of rose hips over a second bowl. Press the rose hips to extract a purée and set aside. Add what's left in the sieve to the saucepan. Add the reserved cooking liquid and the vanilla pod. Return to a simmer and cook for 20 minutes. Strain enough of the mixture into the reserved purée to produce a smooth soup. Stir in sugar to taste. Chill for one hour or until ready to serve.

3 Just before serving, whisk together the cream and yogurt, and sweeten to taste. Stir the lemon juice into the chilled soup, and pour or spoon into glass bowls. Add a sprinkling of almonds, a dollop of whisked cream, and serve chilled with the Amaretti cookies on the side.



ROSE HIPS
Rich in vitamin C, rose hips have an excellent nutritional profile and a distinctive flavor. Make sure you forage for the wild rose hips that grow on shrubs, rather than picking those from the garden.